

You can go to osm.org and find out if your changes have come into effect. You should make it a habit to review the changes that you make before you upload them to the servers.

Editing OSM using Vespucci

You can edit OSM from within Android using Vespucci, which can be installed using *F-Droid*. If Vespucci sounds familiar, it's only because you learnt about Amerigo Vespucci in your history classes. That guy got an entire continent (the Americas) named after him.

Usage of Vespucci is quite straightforward, as images on page 97 demonstrate:

The Walking Papers method

Walking Papers is a site that lets you print aerial maps of your locality, and you can draw features on them using a pencil, relying on your knowledge of the place, and then scan them back to Walking Papers—eventually, you upload the changes to OSM. This is very helpful in mapping village areas.

How do I get help?

General help can be found at help.openstreetmap.org while if you are the IRC type, hit irc.openstreetmap.org (*#osm* and *#osm-dev*). The FAQs are at wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/FAQ while the developer FAQs are at wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/Developer_FAQ. Mailing lists are at lists.openstreetmap.org.

Switch2OSM is an excellent place to begin. To learn about editing, head straight to [learnosm](http://learnosm.org). There are several publications, books and online tutorials available to get you started. Trust me, it's fun and addictive.

How do I help OSM?

There are many ways you can contribute to OSM itself, and the guys running the servers. Here are some possibilities:

1. Use OSM (duh!)
2. Advocate: Write about OSM, blog, speak, etc. Start online radio on

Icecast and spread the word (or is that a bit too radical?)

3. Teach: Create tutorials and videos, publish them on YouTube or Vimeo.
4. Edit the maps: The more data the map has, the more useful it becomes. The more accurate the data gets, the more reliable it becomes. So go ahead and hack the map.
5. The OSM foundation is a non-profit organisation; so how about giving them some of your money?
6. Lead by example: Use OSM in place of proprietary maps when you embed, or send directions to people.

Use cases and case studies

OSM can be used in various scenarios. To give you a couple of known examples, Wikipedia and Flickr use OSM for their mapping needs. Flickr uses OSM to put geo-tagged pictures on maps. Some articles of Wikipedia use OSM to represent areas of the world.

Lesser-known is the use of maps in humanitarian relief projects. The Humanitarian OSM Team (HOT) comprises a number of cartographers who coordinate the creation and distribution of mapping resources to support humanitarian relief efforts in several parts of the world. Haiti

benefited by this project during the earthquake that ravaged the place not too long ago.

These maps can also be used to plan routes during treks or even emergencies. Rescue workers can use the maps to plan escape routes. The data can be used by governments to decide on resource allocation and city planning. The possibilities are endless.

OSM on paper

Apart from the obvious way of exporting the map as an image from the browser for printing, there are better ways to put OSM on paper. One is FieldPapers that lets you print maps and make notes on them, and put them back on the server for later use. Check it out for more features. The project is open source, and you can view the source code on GitHub.

So, the next time you go on a trek, take a print map from OSM with you. Upload the data back to OSM. Click a few geo-tagged photos of awesomeness. We should even organise a mapping marathon, or an OSM Day featuring a day-long map-hacking session and a few talks—and have fun at the same time. There are several mapping projects that you can get involved in. If a zombie apocalypse breaks out tomorrow, I have my maps ready. Do you? 

Reference

- [1] <https://help.openstreetmap.org/>
- [2] <http://switch2osm.org>
- [3] <http://mapnik.org>
- [4] https://www.google.com/intl/en_in/help/terms_maps.html
- [5] https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QM6XlCm_qo
- [6] <https://wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/OsmAnd>
- [7] <http://replicant.us/2010/11/fdroid-a-free-software-alternative-to-google-market/>
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- [11] <http://switch2osm.org/find-out-more/>
- [12] <http://walking-papers.org/>
- [13] https://wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/Humanitarian_OSM_Team
- [14] <http://fieldpapers.org/about.php>
- [15] https://wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/Mapping_projects

By: Yogesh Girikumar

The author is a Linux/Free Software enthusiast.